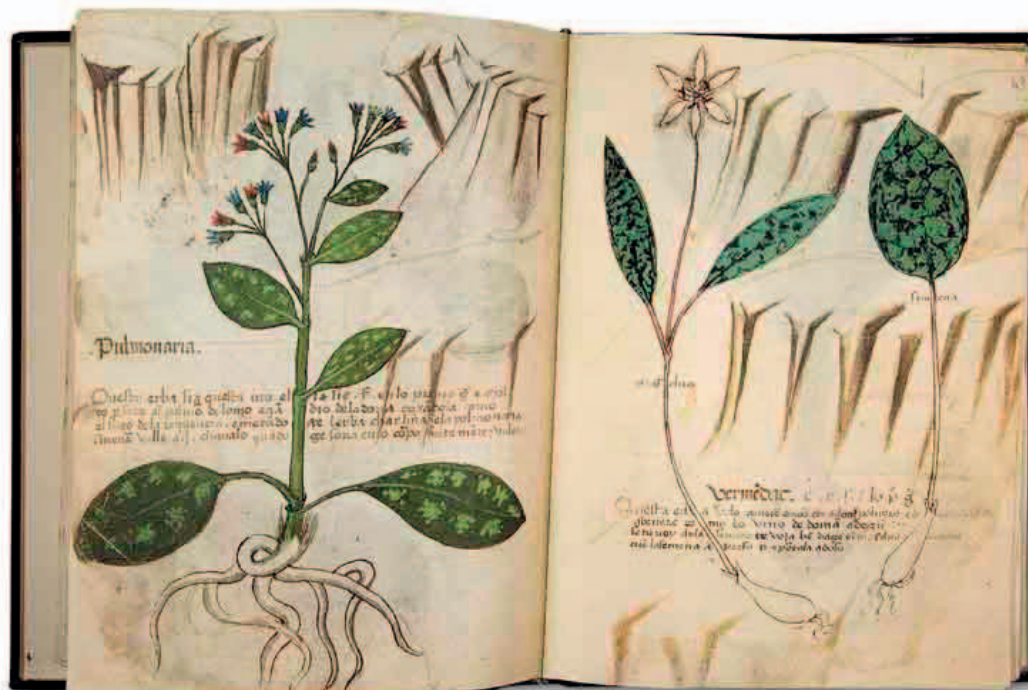
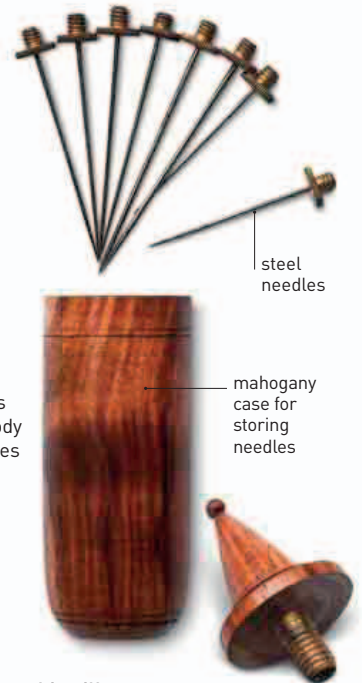




Book of herbs
16th century
Early texts called “herbals” classified plants according to their medicinal properties—or supposed magical powers.



Acupuncture needles
19th century
The earliest evidence of acupuncture dates back to 3000 BCE. Practitioners produced maps of the body to show where the needles would be most effective.



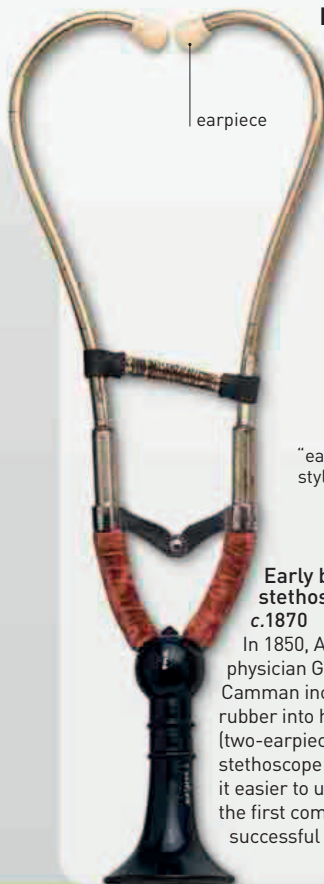
Homeopathic pills
19th century
Homeopathic ideas—that small amounts of a substance that cause symptoms in healthy people can cure similar symptoms caused by disease—originated in Ancient Greece, but German physician Samuel Hahnemann started the formal practice in the 1790s.

MEDICINE

MEDICAL CUSTOMS AND TRADITIONS HAVE GRADUALLY BEEN SUPPLANTED BY A SCIENTIFIC APPROACH

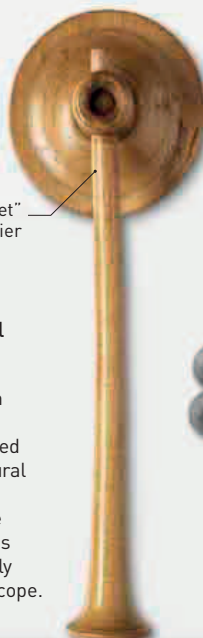
The history of medicine is as old as humanity itself. For thousands of years, breakthroughs in understanding the human body and innovations in technology have improved the way disease is diagnosed and treated.

Evolving from its origins in herbalism and shamanism, medicine flourished in the ancient classical world—where the first physicians assessed patients using scientific judgment. The early study of anatomy, physiology, and diseases, together with its drugs, vaccines, and new instruments, turned medicine into a complex, multifaceted discipline.



Early binaural stethoscope
c.1870

In 1850, American physician George Camman incorporated rubber into his binaural (two-earpiece) stethoscope to make it easier to use. It was the first commercially successful stethoscope.



Wooden stethoscope
1860s

Invented by French physician René Laennec in 1816, the first stethoscope was made from wood. The heart was heard through a funnel, like an ear trumpet.

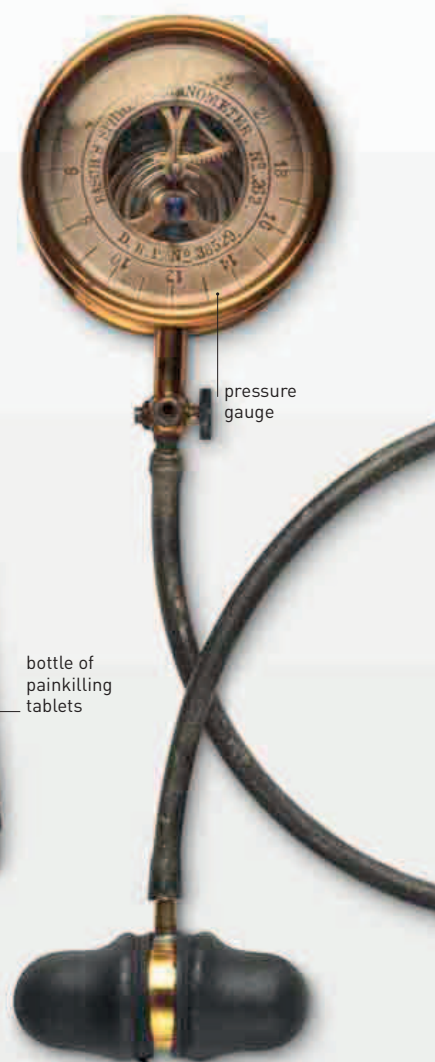


Pills
20th century
Pills accurately deliver a small drug dose. They were first made by encasing the active ingredient in hardened glucose syrup.



Military tablet tin
c.1942

An armament of drugs was used on the battlefield to help deal with injuries and illness to hasten return to duty. Medical officers had first-aid tablet tins that contained painkillers, sedatives, and antiseptics.



pressure gauge

bottle of painkilling tablets